



Syringe Service Program SSP

Strategies and approaches for planning design
and implementation?

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Background:

What is SSP?

Syringe services programs (SSPs) are community-based prevention programs that can provide a range of services, including access to and disposal of sterile syringes and injection equipment, vaccination, testing, and linkage to infectious disease care and substance use treatment.



Infective Endocarditis

Infective endocarditis is a life-threatening inflammation of the heart's chambers and valves that can be difficult and expensive to treat.

Like hepatitis and HIV, **infective endocarditis** can be caused by using needles that are not sterile.

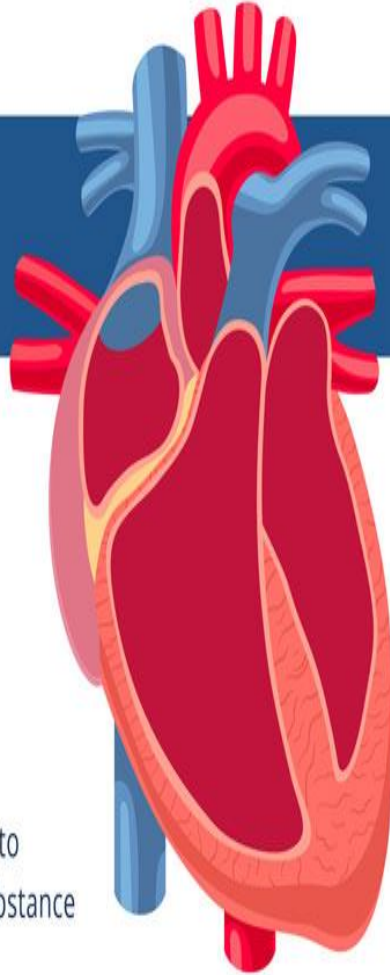
Infective endocarditis associated with injection drug use can be **prevented** by:



Providing **harm reduction services**, including access to sterile injection equipment and promoting safer injection practices



Increasing access to **treatment** for substance use disorders



Source: CDC, NHLBI

Why do we need this?

Sharing and reusing injection equipment is associated with a high risk of transmission of blood-borne diseases including life-threatening infective endocarditis, HIV, hepatitis B, and HCV and skin and soft tissue infections. By providing sterile injection equipment, we aim to reduce transmission of infectious diseases and save lives by significantly reduce HCV transmission and effectively end HIV outbreaks, especially when combined with medications that treat opioid use disorder.

What are we try to achieve or impact for our Veteran Patients?

- SSPs are associated with an estimated 50% reduction in HIV and HCV incidence. When combined with medications that treat opioid dependence.
- The majority of SSPs offer referrals to medication-assisted treatment, and new users of SSPs are five times more likely to enter drug treatment and three times more likely to stop using drugs than those who don't use the programs.
- SSPs prevent overdose deaths by teaching people who inject drugs how to prevent overdose and how to recognize, respond to, and reverse a drug overdose by providing training on how to use naloxone, a medication used to reverse overdose.

Helps stop substance use

The majority of SSPs offer referrals to medication-assisted treatment,⁶ and new users of SSPs are five times more likely to enter drug treatment and three times more likely to stop using drugs than those who don't use the programs.

SSPs prevent overdose deaths by teaching people who inject drugs how to prevent overdose and how to recognize, respond to, and reverse a drug overdose by providing training on how to use naloxone, a medication used to reverse overdose. Many SSPs provide "overdose prevention kits" containing naloxone to people who inject drugs.⁷⁻¹²

Helps support public safety

SSPs have partnered with law enforcement, providing naloxone to local police departments to help them respond and prevent death when someone has overdosed.¹³

SSPs also protect first responders and the public by providing safe needle disposal and reducing the presence of discarded needles in the community.¹⁴⁻¹⁹

In 2015, CDC's National HIV Behavioral Surveillance System found that the more syringes SSPs distributed per the number of people who inject drugs in a geographic region, the more likely the people who inject drugs in that region were to dispose of used syringes safely.²⁰

Studies in Baltimore²¹ and New York City²² have also found no difference in crime rates between areas with and areas without SSPs.

Our Plan:



1 mL BD Insulin Syringe with Permanently Attached Needle

BD
Cat No. Description Packaging

Blister Package

329424	28 G x 1/2 in. U-100 BD Micro-Fine IV (Orange)	100/Box 500/Case
329420	28 G x 1/2 in. U-100 BD Micro-Fine IV Single Unit Graduation	100/Box 500/Case

Self-Contained Package

329410	28 G x 1/2 in. U-100 BD Micro-Fine IV (Orange)	100/Box 500/Case
329412	27 G x 5/8 in. U-100 BD Micro-Fine IV (Orange)	100/Box 500/Case
329411	29 G x 1/2 in. U-100 BD Ultra-Fine	100/Box 500/Case
328418	31 G x 5/16 in. U-100 BD Ultra-Fine II Short Needle	100/Box 500/Case
309309	28 G x 1/2 in. U-100 BD Micro-Fine IV (Orange)	200/Box 1600/Case
309310	27 G x 5/8 in. U-100 BD Micro-Fine IV (Orange)	200/Box 1600/Case
309311	29 G x 1/2 in. U-100 BD Ultra-Fine	200/Box 1600/Case



Testing Your Drugs for Fentanyl
Think about a chocolate chip cookie.

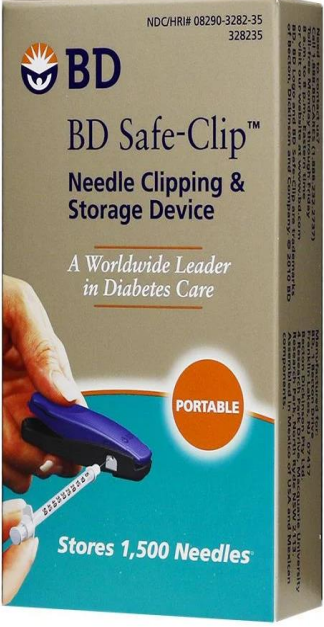
Not every piece of a cookie has chocolate chips in it, and not every piece of a pill or powder may have fentanyl in it. If what you test comes back negative, there still could be fentanyl in another part.

It's best to test all of what you use.
Mix all of what you're using in water and dip the strip (up to the MAX line) into the mix for 10-15 seconds. If it's negative, you could then drink the mix.

But testing some, like the residue left in the baggie, is better than testing none.

Whether positive for fentanyl or not, start low and go slow!
Use a small amount and wait to see how you feel before using more. Never use alone and always have naloxone (Narcan) available.

Test strips, naloxone, and more at IdahoHarmReductionProject.org

BD
BD Safe-Clip™
Needle Clipping & Storage Device

A Worldwide Leader in Diabetes Care

PORTABLE

Stores 1,500 Needles



Purell
ADVANCED
HAND SANITIZER

KILLS 99.9% OF GERMS*
Leaves hands feeling soft.

REFRESHING GEL

33.8 FL OZ (1 L)



BAND-AID
FLEXIBLE FABRIC

Comfortable protection that stretches and flows as you move.
Stays on for up to 24 hours.

100 ALL-ONE SIZE



NEOSPORIN
ORIGINAL OINTMENT



NARCAN (naloxone HCl)
NASAL SPRAY 4 mg

DO NOT TEST DEVICES OR OPEN BOX BEFORE USE.
Use for known or suspected opioid overdoses in adults and children.

Two Pack



BD ALCOHOL SWAB

**NATIONAL REHAB
HOTLINE**



Roseburg VA
Healthcare System

Street Safety Kit

Free for All Veterans



What is this Program for?

It is a public health strategy for persons who inject drugs (PWID). It aims to reduce HIV infection, viral hepatitis, and other blood-borne infections by promoting the use of new or sterile injection equipment for each injection.

What are Needle Clippers?

Clip & store used needles, replacing the need for Sharps containers. Able to store up to 1,500 needles. Throw in trash when full.



<- Needle Clipper

What about Naloxone?

Available upon request. Requires prescription & necessary documentation forms.**

Where to Find Kits:

Ask for your free kit at the pharmacy, APU, mental health or urgent care. **

Starter Kit:

- Storage fanny pack
- 10 sterile and clean syringes
- 10 alcohol wipes
- 1 Needle Clipper
- 10 adhesive bandages
- <insert item here>
- <insert item here>

Refill Kit:

- <insert item here>
- <insert item here>
- <insert item here>
- <insert item here>



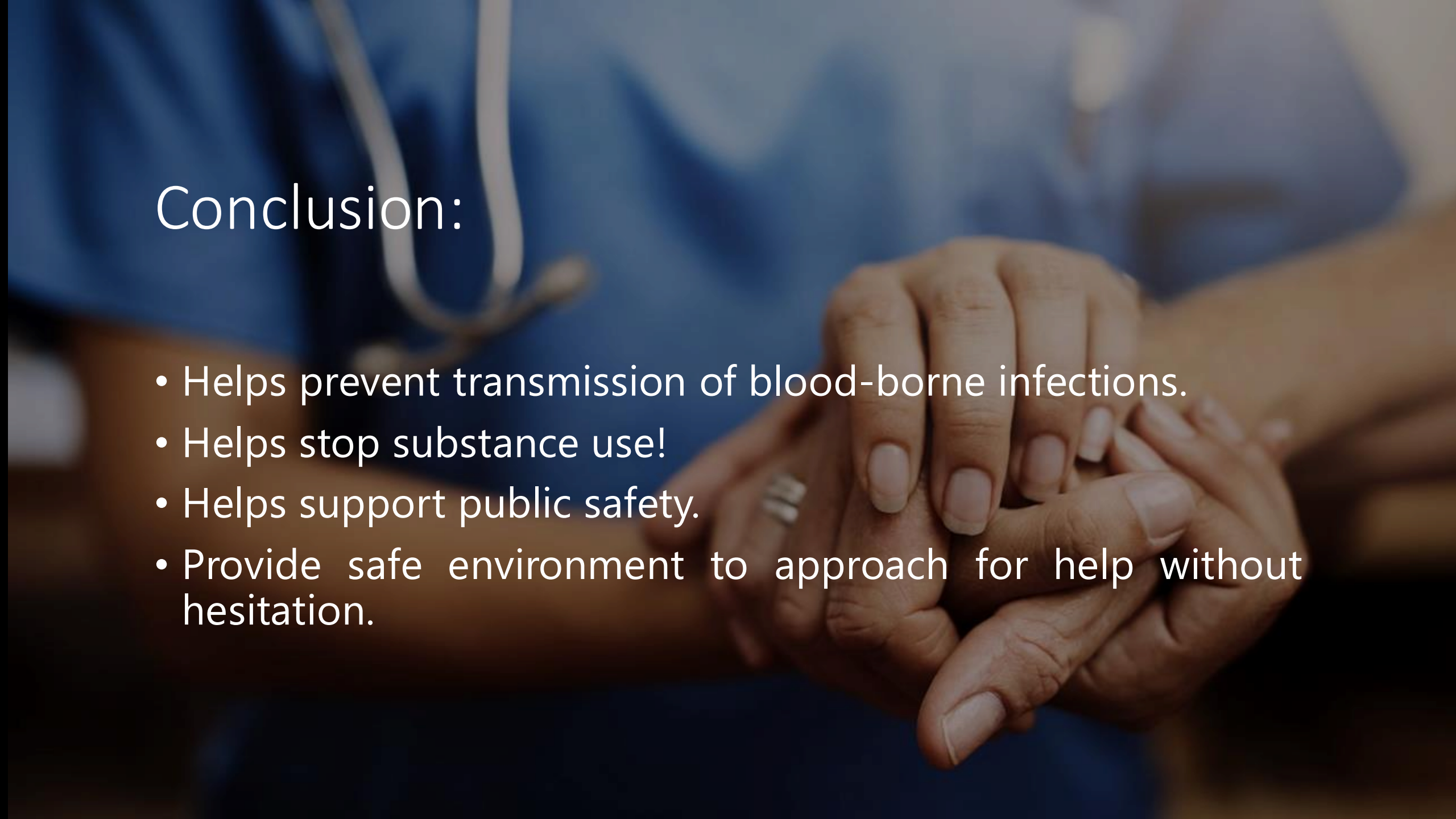
Flyer for Our Veterans

We are planning to Post information Flyers in the areas where it's more visible for incoming patients like Urgent Care, Outside Pharmacy Pickup window, Cafeteria, Hallways and Elevators.



Outcome we hope for:

- SSPs have partnered with law enforcement, providing naloxone to local police departments to help them respond and **prevent death when someone has overdosed.**
- NIDA-funded research has found that syringe services programs do not increase drug use. In fact, program participants in these studies were significantly more likely to enter **substance use treatment and reduce or stop drug use.**
- Syringe services programs have been found to be an effective and cost-effective strategy for **preventing and addressing community outbreaks of HIV and HCV.** An outbreak in rural Scott County, Indiana, beginning in 2015 led to more than 200 people being diagnosed with both HIV and HCV. The Indiana State Department of Health credited syringe services programs with halting the increase in transmissions and saving taxpayers an estimated \$120 million.
- Comprehensive syringe services programs are associated with a **decrease in syringe litter in the community,** in part because they allow people to safely dispose of used syringes. This may in turn decrease the risk of accidental needlestick injuries. In a 2012 NIDA-funded study, researchers found 86% fewer used syringes in parks and sidewalks



Conclusion:

- Helps prevent transmission of blood-borne infections.
- Helps stop substance use!
- Helps support public safety.
- Provide safe environment to approach for help without hesitation.